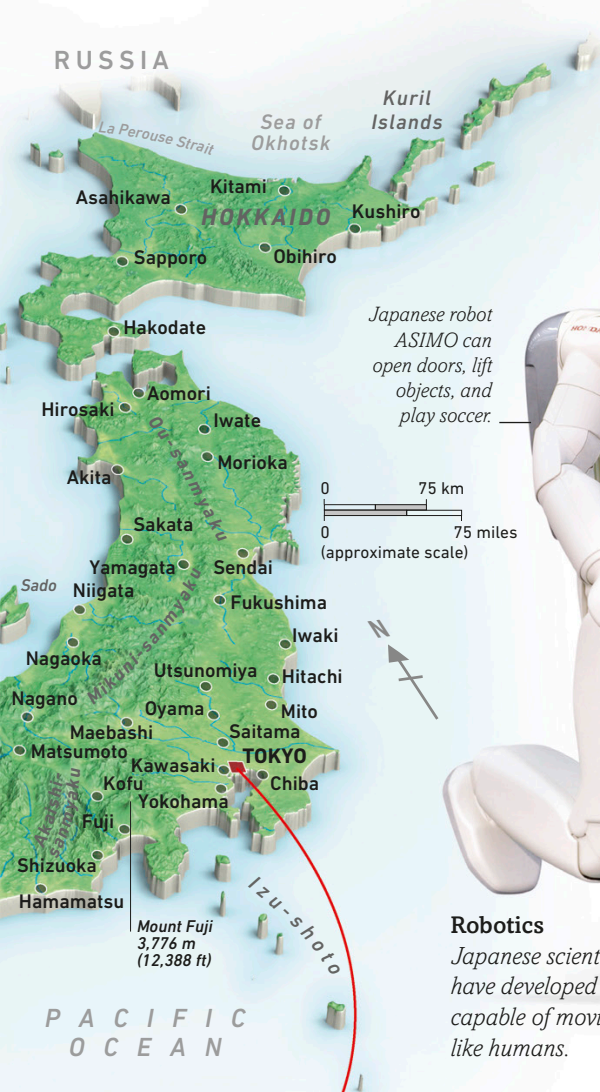


RUSSIA



Japanese robot ASIMO can open doors, lift objects, and play soccer.



Robotics

Japanese scientists have developed robots capable of moving like humans.



Capital city

Tokyo is the world's largest urban area, with more than 35 million people.



Japanese macaques

Monkeys called macaques grow thick fur to keep warm in snowy northern Japan and even bathe in hot springs to escape the freezing temperatures.

Cherry blossom
Nature is celebrated in Japan, with crowds of people flocking to local parks to view the pretty pink cherry blossoms in bloom every spring.



Kimono

For special occasions, such as weddings and temple visits, the kimono is worn. Both men and women wear this formal clothing.



日本

Calligraphy

Shodo, a form of calligraphy, is the creation of decorative symbols and lettering by brush or pen. This Japanese art form dates back centuries.



Geography: Japan consists of many **islands** on the Pacific Ocean. Three-quarters of the landscape is **mountainous**.



History: The earliest settlers arrived about **30,000 years ago**. Over the centuries, Japan has seen both **imperial** and **military** rule.



Culture: From **calligraphy**, **poetry**, and **theater** to **bonsai**, **origami**, and **martial arts**, a wide variety of customs and traditions is at the heart of Japanese culture.



Natural wonders: More than **100 volcanoes** dot the country. The most famous is **Mount Fuji**.



Wildlife: Much of Japan is covered in **forests**—a haven for wildlife such as **macaques**, **bears**, **squirrels**, and **wild boar**.



Food and drink: People eat a healthy **diet rich in fish**. Japan is known for its **green tea**, consumed **without milk**.